

Coinbase: a new infrastructure VP and strong network intent

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: ZoomInfo, Apollo

97 Networking Solutions intent, audience A	91 Data Center intent (Sep 5)	Aug 2026 Brian Foster becomes VP, Infrastructure	0 touches so far
STAGE Untouched prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF SCORE - Tier A call-first (Brian Foster), launched Oct 1-2	LAST TOUCH None	NEXT STEP Tue Oct 6: call task for Brian Foster (+1 508-730-8814); cadence email first

Bottom line

Coinbase runs a regulated derivatives exchange (Coinbase Derivatives, built from Chicago-based FairX) alongside its crypto business. In September ZoomInfo showed **Networking Solutions 97 (audience A)**, **Data Center 91**, **Networking/Telecom 80** and **Bandwidth 74**. **Brian Foster became VP of Infrastructure in August 2026** after running Coinbase's wholesale business, and he's leading the **Citi partnership** (Sep 28). A new VP plus strong intent is the best timing we'll get. **Zach Lanier, Director of Network and Systems Engineering (ex-Amazon)**, is the technical owner; he has no email, so use LinkedIn.

What Coinbase is, in one analogy

A new VP is a new head chef: in the first 90 days he re-checks every supplier. Get on his list before the menu is set.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Networking Solutions 97 (A, Sep 19), Data Center 91 (Sep 5), Networking/Telecom 80, Bandwidth 74	ZoomInfo intent	Active network research.
Brian Foster: VP, Infrastructure since Aug 2026; ex-Global Head of Wholesale	Apollo	New owner; first-90-days window.
Citi partnership for institutional payments (Sep 28)	ZoomInfo scoop	Institutional growth.
SEC tokenized-stock exemption (Sep 17)	ZoomInfo scoop	New products, more trading traffic.

Work already in motion

No activity.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
-	-	No HubSpot or Lemlist activity	Fresh
Oct 1-2	CTF SCORE - Tier A call-first	Brian Foster enrolled with a personal opening line	Live

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Brian Foster	VP, Infrastructure (Apollo)	New York	New owner.	Not contacted. brian.foster@coinbase.com (verified)
Zach Lanier	Director, Network and Systems Engineering (Apollo)	New Jersey	Technical owner.	Not contacted. LinkedIn only
Geoff Huffman	Senior Network Engineer (Apollo)	Texas	Technical.	Not contacted. geoff.huffman@coinbase.com (verified)

Not worth chasing for this goal

Blockchain and software infrastructure engineers (cloud, not fiber); infrastructure marketing.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Brian Foster VP, Infrastructure

Why them: New in role; derivatives in Chicago.

Channel: Email Tue Oct 6 | Subject: Coinbase Derivatives' Chicago paths

Brian, congrats on the infrastructure role. With the derivatives exchange tied to Chicago, the physical routes there are worth a look. Crosstown owns underground fiber on-net at 350 E Cermak and Elk Grove, mapped to the conduit so diversity is provable. Who on Zach's team should get our map?

2. Zach Lanier Director, Network and Systems Engineering

Why them: Technical owner.

Channel: LinkedIn Wed Oct 7 | Subject: (connection note)

Zach, I run Chicago for Crosstown Fiber: underground routes into Cermak and Elk Grove, mapped to the conduit. Happy to share the KMZ for your Chicago planning.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Tue Oct 6	Email Brian Foster.	-
Wed Oct 7	LinkedIn connect to Zach Lanier.	-
Mon Oct 12	Email Geoff Huffman with the KMZ.	-
Week of Oct 19	Goal: intro call with Lanier's team.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply or referral from Foster	Logged
Oct 30	Intro call held	Meeting logged
Dec 15	Quote requested	Deal created

Guardrails

- Ignore general market news ZoomInfo tagged to Coinbase (Paramount, AMD, Anthropic).
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company; 3 Apollo person enrichments.

Sources

ZoomInfo intent and scoops; Apollo people data.